
Why staging lies

Every place staging differs from production is where the incidents come from. A green run is evidence about staging.

Presenter · Team

No figures in this deck — the argument is mechanical, and no gap here can be sized from a source we can cite.

A green run is evidence about staging

01

Build a model

Staging is production with the expensive parts removed.

02

Test the model

The suite exercises that model and comes back green.

03

Claim the original

We report the result as if it were a fact about production.

A green staging run is a true statement about staging. It turns false the moment we read it as a statement about production.

No figures in this deck — the argument is mechanical, and no gap here can be sized from a source we can cite.

Four gaps, and what each one hides

01 Data

Fixtures are small, clean and recent.
Your worst row is none of those.

02 Traffic shape

Tests arrive one at a time. Production
arrives all at once.

03 Mocked dependencies

A mock returns what you expected.
The real one returns a timeout.

04 Scale and topology

One node cannot show what only
happens between nodes.

No figures in this deck — the argument is mechanical, and no gap here can be sized from a source we can cite.

Two honest options, and one we keep choosing

Close the gap

Price: a second production, fully staffed.

- Production-shaped data, refreshed
- Real dependencies, not mocks
- Load and topology that match

Shrink staging

Price: production tooling we do not have.

- Boot and wiring proved, nothing more
- Correctness moves behind flags
- Canaries and fast rollback carry it

Both are honest. Keeping the gap and keeping the claim is not.

No figures in this deck — the argument is mechanical, and no gap here can be sized from a source we can cite.

What we need to decide

01 Which gaps do we close?

Name them, price them, give each an owner and a date.

02 Which gaps do we admit to?

Write them down as known-untested surface, not as an oversight.

03 What does a staging pass stop meaning?

Agree the sentence we say instead, and put it in the release template.

Until we decide, a staging pass means one thing: the code ran somewhere.

No figures in this deck — the argument is mechanical, and no gap here can be sized from a source we can cite.